

Communication Subcommittee Meeting

Notes

3.2.2021

5:00 PM

Via Zoom

5:02 pm: Jenny Graham: read introduction

Roll: Melanie McLaughlin and Kathy Kreatz present. Jenny, Chair, present.

Jenny Graham: Topic: Strategic Planning: need to get feedback from the community

Jenny Graham sharing screen

Goal to separate the what from the how.

What are we trying to accomplish with this strategic plan?

The strategic plan needs to be pinned to our mission and vision statement.

Two different missions on the website, one for MPS and one for MHS. No stated vision statement on the web.

Precursor to sessions I am thinking about in collecting community input.

What questions can we be asking during the roundtables so that policy makers can address the expectations of the community.

Often the first thing that becomes clear is that the mission statement and vision may be dated.

Does the mission statement accurately reflect the goals MPS should aspire to?

Does the current mission statement adequately what you feel MPS should achieve in the next x number of years?

Why or why not and what changes do you have?

What key actions does MPS need to take to execute the vision? In what time frame do these steps need to be taken.

Perhaps the roundtables can be 1.5 hours. Breakout rooms by level. There are special populations out there that may want to have a separate breakout room? (EL or SPED) Translator?

Feedback on proposed structure?

Back in the spring, there were topical breakouts but there may be different needs now.

Do we group by level or by topic? Athletics, extracurriculars, learning and instruction.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: My wondering about question number 1 (long range goals): are we talking about instructional and academic programming? That is a different arena. With long range goals, are we talking about physical plant, additional languages or coursework? Do you want to leave it open ended and broad?

Jenny Graham: Mission: Mission: why do we get out of bed in the morning? Stands the test of time.

Vision: This is what it is going to look like at the end of the strategic plan. Lexington's plan does a great job: compelling mission and the vision jumps off the page. When you talk about them differently, you get different things about them. We can and should expect that the community will come to us with what is on their mind. Trying to ask the questions as grounding statements in the beginning.

Melanie McLaughlin: It would be helpful for people to see the results from the breakout sessions last time. I would love to see a summary of what the roundtables did last year. We did a lot of workshopping. It would be nice to look at that before we start so it doesn't feel like we are starting from scratch.

Jenny Graham: The Mayor's transition planning sessions at the library?

Melanie McLaughlin: Yes. Not the back to school in COVID sessions. There will be some crossover with the back to school piece like Equity which is universal. I can reach out to the Mayor to get that report.

Jenny Graham: Perhaps we can weave in the roundtables we did last year with back to school. Among the great feedback we received..... Way to give value to the feedback we received from the community.

Kathy Kreatz: when we begin the process to inviting people to the roundtables, will be give background information about the current mission statement so that they can come ready with ideas, suggestions and feedback.

Jenny Graham: That is a great idea.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: My only ask is that we are on a tight timetable, is that we try to get the plan to a place to be able to guide all the work we are doing moving forward. That is how we know that we are aligned and that we are getting traction. I would like to have a strong plan by the end of this year so we can adequately for next year. I just want us to be cognizant of how much we aim to accomplish with this set of roundtables, knowing that we need to open the schools. I am less worried about having a strong start next year because we have systems and structures in place. I am more concerned about having the strategic plan in place and executing accordingly. I am optimistic we will get people vaccinated soon and I would love to have the strategic plan approved.

Jenny Graham: When we met last month, we mentioned doing these in April so we can present it in June. I feel it is reasonable to get this done early April to give your team and the SC the time to get it done. Sounds like the budget discussion will lag a bit as we wait for updates from the Biden Administration. We can try for the week of April 5 to get it off the ground. You already have the bones and the framework of the plan. I feel it needs to be aligned with the community expectation, not necessarily making changes to the how or changing what you are currently doing.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: I follow what you are saying. When you speak of the vision/mission work, the schools have individual mission/vision statements. Each school has its own personality. We are looking at the district level mission statement and vision. I don't want the other school communities to feel that we are saying goodbye to their individuality. We are all part of one family. I definitely encourage the individuality of the schools but at the same time, we want to come up with a mission and vision statement that is inclusive of all.

Jenny Graham: That is a natural evolution. The organization sets the plan and then the sub organizations can take it and align to the plan going forward. Does looking at the week of April 6 make sense?

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: We have the next comm meeting on April 6 and the rules committee on April 7. There is no regular meeting that week. Monday the 5th is open right now.

Kathy Kreatz: Could we use the sub meeting date of April 6 for the roundtable?

Jenny Graham: Yes. That makes sense. We could do the 5th and the 6th.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: Yes that would work. Are you envisioning 90 minutes?

Jenny Graham: Yes. Maybe we could do 5 to 6:30 and later the other day so more people can attend?

Kathy Kreatz: how about 6 to 7:30 for the second one?

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: I think that makes sense. Because of all the breakout rooms, I will have to coordinate with the admin team. Which would happen which date/time?

Jenny Graham: whatever works for you?

Kathy Kreatz: same

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: I will work with the administrators to see what works for everyone? I will confirm that and let you know.

Jenny Graham: We can confirm it when we approve the minutes on Monday at SC meeting.

Other point is to create a survey that we can give to people who cannot attend the meetings. I pulled these questions from the survey that we used during the superintendent search meetings. The survey should be translated as well.

Thoughts/questions:

Melanie McLaughlin: How well will these questions translate? It might be worth sharing with constituents?

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: Could you ask the same question but you might have to break it out differently?

Difference between social and academic language.

Jenny Graham: they are all multiple choice questions. This was the result of the superintendent search survey. Survey monkey itself recommends these allocations. I would recommend them as they are.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: Do they offer unsure as an option?

Jenny Graham: Yes. It probably be better to finalize the questions when the roundtables are done?

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: With the survey piece going out after April Vacation, how long would the survey be open for?

Jenny Graham: two weeks tops. We would need some time to finalize the survey. It could go out in the Friday communication right before the vacation week.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: I definitely can keep putting the link in more than once.

Jenny Graham: Any other questions or thoughts. I will share the document with you and Suzi as well.

Melanie McLaughlin: Are we meeting one more time before we do this?

Jenny Graham: We are not. We are not scheduled to.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: March is a packed month so we have two regularly scheduled meetings this month during which we could include it during New Business if need be.

Motion to approve proposed roundtable plan and survey: Melanie McLaughlin, 2nd Kathy Kreatz

Jenny Graham;yes, Kathy Kreatz: yes, Melanie McLaughlin: yes motion passes

That is the end of the agenda!!

Motion to adjourn. Melanie McLaughlin, Kathy Kreatz

ROLL: Jenny Graham;yes, Kathy Kreatz: yes, Melanie McLaughlin: yes motion passes